Unit 12 Environmental Concerns and Globalisation



Learning Objectives

- To understand the need for protecting global environment.
- To trace the origin, development, role and significance of various multilateral environmental mechanisms.
- To assess India's stance on international environmentalism.
- To introduce students to the concept of indigeneity, indigenous people and indigenous rights.
- To explore the ever-growing realm of globalisation with special reference to India.

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Quotable Quote

"If conservation of natural resources goes wrong, nothing else will go right"

- M. S. Swaminathan

12.1 Protection of Global Environment

The protection of environment as a global requirement is a post-industrialization revelation. Major concerns like deforestation, industrial pollution, greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, depletion of ozone layer, global warming and the consequent rise sea levels etc. have been acknowledged to be matters that require immediate and serious interventions given the adverse impacts they cause. In 1982, the UN General Assembly, through its "World Charter for Nature", underscored that the entire humanity is a part of nature, and life depends on nature. The idea of sustainable development that propels the contemporary debate of environmentalism focusses immensely on conservation of biodiversity in terms of prevention of environmental pollution, protection of wetlands, and promotion of ecological balance. Globally, the UN continues to be the lynchpin in global environmental governance, through its organs and various specialized agencies.

Top Ten Global Carbon Emitters

1. China	6. Japan
2. The US	7. Germany
3. The EU	8. Iran
4. India	9. Saudi Arabia
5. Russia	10. South Korea

Genesis of Institutional Protection of Environment

The topics of securitization and protection of environment is a natural offshoot of the complex relations that exist between the human life and ecology. Nature in its capacity as a life-supporting system has various implications across different spectra including ecology, peace, conflict, human rights and security. Given the irreplaceable role played by nature in the sustenance

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